VIRTUAL UNIVERSITY OF PAKISTAN

M.A. Jinnah Campus, Defence Road Off Raiwind Road, Lahore

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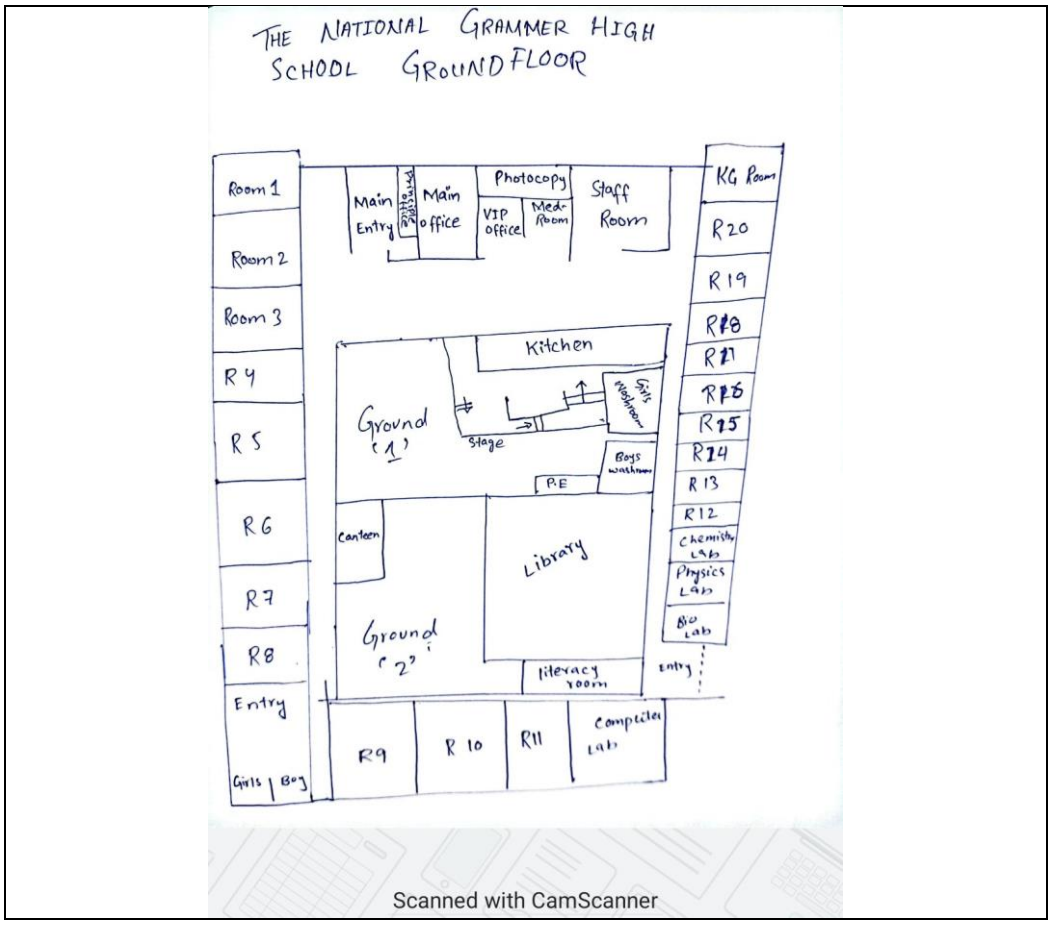
Week 2: Observation of Cooperating Teacher

Observation of Cooperating Teacher and Classroom activities provide you an opportunity to learn how your Cooperating Teacher engages with the students and carries out the teaching process. These observations also help you to familiarize with the classroom layout, delivery of a lesson, giving instructions, planning homework, and how to evaluate students.

Activity 1: Observation of Classroom Layout/Set-up

The purpose of this activity is to gather information on how a teacher uses the space in the classroom and ensures that all the students are engaged.

Task: Sketch the sitting arrangement of the classroom (blackboard, students' desk and chairs, teacher's desk, door etc.)



Reflection: Based on your observation of classroom layout, answer the following questions.

1. How this seating plan was helpful in involving all students in lesson?

The arrangement of classroom seating significantly influences classroom management. A well-structured seating plan can positively impact student behavior, academic performance, and class participation. Research also indicates that students tend to perform better when their seats are assigned rather than when they select their own.

2. Did the seating plan facilitate group work during any activity? (where applicable)

During my observations, I found that the physical arrangement of chairs, tables, and presentation spaces in a classroom plays a crucial role in shaping the learning environment. According to instructional communication theory, seating arrangements influence both instructor-student communication and peer interaction, affecting engagement, motivation, and focus. Recent studies further indicate that students generally favor flexible seating options. Specifically, they tend to prefer classrooms with mobile chairs and trapezoidal tables equipped with casters over those with fixed chairs and rectangular tables.

3. What changes would you like to make in this classroom seating plan?

The changes I would implement in this classroom seating plan include regularly updating the seating arrangement, either weekly or monthly. This approach allows students to experience a change of scenery, which can be refreshing and beneficial. Additionally, frequently altering the seating plan helps address potential distractions, such as separating overly talkative students by ensuring they don't remain seated near each other for extended periods.

Activity 2: Observation of Classroom Teaching

The purpose of this activity is to observe how a teacher has planned lesson and his/her teaching styles while conducting the lesson plan (discuss with your cooperating teacher about this activity and request him/her to provide lesson plan before the start of the class). This activity has two parts. In 1st part you will observe the teacher in classroom and reflect on it. In 2nd part you will prepare your own lesson plan based on your observation.

Part 1: Review of Lesson Plan (If available)

Review the Lesson plan according to the format given below.

Cooperating Teacher: **Mr. Adnan** class: **9th** Subject: **Biology**
Topic: **Biodiversity** Subtopics: **Five-Kingdom Classification System**

Note: Give your comments on the lesson plan.

Elements	Yes, No	Comment (if any)
The lesson plan has all the elements according to the model lesson plan/format (provided to you)	Yes	A good lesson plan
General Objectives/ specific objectives are clearly stated	Yes	States the objectives very clearly
Objectives are in behavioral form (using Blooms' or SOLO) taxonomy	Yes	No
Methodology is clear and relevant to the topic	Yes	Methods used: Flipping classsrooms
AV aids/ Materials/ Resources to teach this particular lesson/topic are mentioned	Yes	
Activity/ Group work is planned (where applicable)	Yes	
Worksheet is available/ready (if required any)	Yes	
Learning sequence/ Procedure is present e.g. checking prior knowledge, introduction, explanation, activity, homework	Yes	
Feedback of students (questioning/answering)	Yes	
Homework is mentioned/given	Yes	

Reflection: Reflect how successfully teacher has delivered the lesson.

1. Did the teacher check the prior knowledge of the students about topic? (give example)

The teacher employed various methods to evaluate students' prior knowledge and skills. These included direct measures like tests, concept maps, portfolios, and auditions, as well as indirect methods such as self-report and inventories of previous courses and experiences.

2. Did the teacher respond to students' questions during the lesson? Were the questions relevant to the topic?

Yes, the teacher responds to the student's questions during the lesson and the questions asked by
The students are related to the topic in the period.

3. What strategies teacher mentioned in lesson plan to motivate students?

The teacher incorporates the following strategies outlined in the lesson plan to motivate students:

- Encouraging a growth mindset instead of a fixed mindset.
- Building meaningful and respectful relationships with students.
- Fostering a collaborative and supportive learning community in the classroom.

- Setting high expectations and clearly defined goals.

4. Which aspects of this lesson plan needs to be reviewed again and why?

There is often uncertainty about what defines a very good or outstanding lesson. Teachers must understand how to evaluate teaching effectiveness and instructional quality. Additionally, they need to provide constructive feedback to enhance teaching standards and ensure continuous learning. It is essential to identify the characteristics of an exceptional lesson and use this understanding to evaluate and prioritize feedback based on the situation and desired learning outcomes. Your valuable insights on this matter would be greatly appreciated.

5. How the teacher prepared black board e.g. writing date, topic name, and classwork? Is the blackboard work clear/neat/understandable?

The teacher utilized the blackboard, which offers several advantages: it is cost-effective, reusable, allows students to follow the teacher's pace, and does not rely on electricity. Chalk, used for writing, is affordable, easy to handle, odorless, and effective for presenting both written and visual ideas.

6. How did the teacher prepare students' Homework task? Was the homework relevant with the objectives of the topic?

The teacher prepared the homework task by aligning it with the objectives of the topic, "Five Kingdom Classification System." The assigned homework was designed to reinforce the key concepts discussed in class, ensuring its relevance to the lesson's learning goals. The tasks encouraged students to review and apply their understanding of the classification system in a meaningful way.

7. Observe the notebook of any two students to see if those are properly checked or not?

I observe the notebook of four students instead of two and I find those are fully and properly checked with teacher sign and date

8. How was the teacher monitoring students' participation in class? (e.g. verbal/nonverbal responses)

The teacher explains a simple topic to students who may not fully grasp the concepts. It is important for the teacher to ensure that all students understand the material, so the teacher allocates time for discussion

after the lecture. With a 45-minute lecture, the teacher covers the topic in 30-35 minutes and reserves the remaining 5-10 minutes for student discussions**.**

9. Reflect on what you have learned after observing this activity?

Various aspects of the class can be learned, such as routines, use of time, schedule, participation, Teaching strategies, management strategies, learner interest, and much more.

Part 2: Recreate Lesson plan

Recreate this lesson plan as you want to teach this topic. You may use the University format to create your own version of Lesson plan for the same topic.

- **Subject:** Biology
- **Class:** 9th
- **Text Book:** Punjab text book
- **Topic and Sub-topic: Biodiversity (Five-Kingdom Classification System**
- **Lecture Duration:** 45 minutes

Lesson Objectives:

By the end of the lecture, students should be able to:

1. Understand the concept of biological classification.
2. Identify the five kingdoms of life: Monera, Protista, Fungi, Plantae, and Animalia.
3. Understand the characteristics and examples of organisms in each kingdom.
4. Explain the significance of the Five Kingdom Classification System in biology.

Materials Needed:

- Whiteboard and markers
- Text Book of biology
- Diagrams/Charts of the Five Kingdom Classification

Teaching Method:

- Lecture delivered using whiteboard
- Discussion session at the end of the class
- Visual aids (charts, diagrams)

Lesson Plan Breakdown:

Time	Activity	Details
0 - 5 min	**Introduction to the Topic**	- Greet students and introduce the topic of biological classification. - Provide an overview of the importance of classification in biology. - Briefly introduce the Five Kingdom Classification System.
5 - 15 min	**Explanation of Biological Classification**	- Define biological classification and its purpose in organizing living organisms. - Introduce Carl Linnaeus and his contributions to the classification system.
15 - 25 min	**The Five Kingdoms: Overview**	- Introduce each of the five kingdoms: Monera, Protista, Fungi, Plantae, and Animalia. - Provide a detailed description of each kingdom with examples (e.g., Monera – bacteria, Protista – amoeba).
25 - 35 min	**Characteristics of Each Kingdom**	- Discuss the characteristics that define each kingdom. - Explain the main differences between kingdoms (e.g., unicellular vs. multicellular, autotrophic vs. heterotrophic).
35 - 40 min	**Summary and Recap**	- Summarize the key points of the Five Kingdom Classification System. - Clarify any questions from students regarding the kingdoms.
40 - 45 min	**Discussion and Q&A**	- Open the floor for student questions and discussion. - Encourage students to discuss any points of confusion. - Conclude by emphasizing the significance of this classification in understanding biodiversity.

Assessment:

- **Formative:** Continuous questioning and engagement during the lecture.
- **Summative:** Short quiz or assignment in the next class to assess understanding of the Five Kingdom Classification System.

Homework/Assignments:

- Research one organism from each of the five kingdoms and prepare a short assignment (2-3 minutes) on their characteristics.

Activity 3: Observation of Classroom Activity/Group work

The purpose of this activity is to check both the clarity of instructions given by teacher and students' understanding to follow instructions to perform an activity or group work.

Teacher's Instructional skills

Observe the instructions the teacher is giving before starting and during the activity and complete the table. For each skill, decide how successfully it was achieved, (Clear and Unclear) and write your reflection against each observation.

Instruction-giving skills	Clear, Unclear	Discussion points (if any)
Start of activity (explaining the purpose of activity)	**Clear**	No
Use of simple language/short sentences	**Clear**	No
Voice quality (loud)	**Clear**	No
Follow up instructions during the activity	**Clear**	No
Use of visual aids (where applicable)	**Clear**	No
Demonstration rather than explanation	**Clear**	No
End of activity (summarization)	**Clear**	No

Reflection:

1. In case of group work; how the teacher decided students for grouping and also mentioned the number of students in one group? What responsibilities were assigned to each member of the group?

Student participation in group work is a crucial aspect of the learning process. When students can express their ideas, listen to each other, engage in meaningful discussions, and collaborate to create shared outcomes, they become more actively involved in their learning. There are various ways a teacher can organize students for group work, and a skilled teacher may choose different strategies to achieve different objectives. In each group, there are three members, and responsibilities are assigned to each student to coordinate with one another and complete the task successfully.

2. How all the students were participating in the group work? How teacher ensured the participation of each student?

Group work can be an effective way to motivate students, promote active learning, and foster essential skills such as critical thinking, communication, and decision-making. However, without proper planning and guidance, group work can lead to frustration for both students and instructors and may end up feeling unproductive.

3. Were all the students following the instructions and completing the activity?

Yes, all the students following the instructions and completing the activity very well.

4. Reflect on what you have learned after observing this activity/group work?

I learned that group work can help students develop a wide range of skills that are becoming increasingly important in the professional world. Positive group experiences have been shown to enhance student learning, retention, and overall academic success. When structured effectively, group projects can strengthen skills that are valuable for both team-based and individual work, such as the ability to:

- Break down complex tasks into manageable steps
- Plan and manage time efficiently
- Deepen understanding through discussion and explanation
- Provide and receive constructive feedback
- Question assumptions
- Improve communication skills.

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Activity 6: Co-operating Teacher Form

Checklist to evaluate Student-Teacher Activities

Dear Cooperating Teacher,

You are requested to please sign the following checklist, based on the review of these activities performed by the student-teacher.

Sr.#	Activity	Performed	Not performed
1	Log of Daily Activities	Performed	
2	Record of School Resources	Performed	
3	Interview with the Cooperating-Teacher	Performed	
4	Interview with the Student/s	Performed	
5	Community/Co-Curricular Engagement	Performed	

Signature of Cooperating Teacher:

School Stamp: Principal
The National Grammar High School & Jaranwala

Date: 5-12-2024